

let's figure out the first step in choosing the right monitor – that is, which panel should you go for?

TN Panels

The most common panel type in the market, TN's are as old as commercially viable LCD technology itself. If your TV manufacturer hasn't listed out an some exotic technology underpinning the panel, chances are it's the good ol' TN panel. Because this panel type's simplicity and the fact that it has existed for donkey's years, this allows it to be ubiquitous due to cheaper manufacturing cost. However, low cost isn't its only trick. TN panels are by far the quickest when it comes to response time. That is, the pixels within



this panel are capable of changing their state quickly and thereby reduce motion artefacts such as blur. That's why nearly all gaming monitors that support some sort of high refresh rate technology happen to be TN panels. Monitors that also incorporate active LCD shutter based 3D support usually employ TN panels because the 3D implementation requires monitors capable of frame rates upwards of 120 Hz. Modern TN panels catering to gamers promise better motion handling and smoother experience by incorporating true 144 Hz refresh rates. This isn't meant for 3D implementation, but to offer fluid gameplay experience for FPS gamers, where faster screen refreshes makes the difference between a frag and getting fragged.

It's cheap, fast, and perfect for gaming, so what's the catch, you ask. Well, the prime weakness of this panel tragically happens to be picture quality.